

ALTER EGO

Nigamanth P

nigamanth.p@thehindu.co.in

Shi Ming snatched a UFC contract in spectacular fashion in the Road to UFC strawweight finale, putting Feng Xiaocan to sleep with a thudding head kick in the opening minutes of the third round.

Feng never stood up after that. After an initial inspection, she was stretchered out by medical professionals and taken immediately

to a local hospital. The UFC broadcast reported that the 22-year-old was conscious and talking at the time she was placed on the stretcher.

Shi, who is currently on a five-fight win streak, earned not just a contract but also a \$50,000 Performance of the Night award.

Zhang Weili, the first Asian UFC champion and current women's strawweight titleholder, watched the match and was caught on camera expressing her excitement over Shi's knockout, stating it made her "hair stand on end."

Since 2020, Shi has reportedly claimed 12 MMA championships across China, South Korea, and Myanmar. But what makes this victory significant? Her story.

Shi, nicknamed Dr. Sleep, is a full-time medical practitioner specialising in

Shi Ming, a full-time medical practitioner, not only earned a UFC contract but also a **\$50,000** Performance of the Night award after beating Feng Xiaocan.

acupuncture. Hailing from Heilongjiang, China, the grappler began training in taekwondo when she was 13 and transitioned to MMA in her 20s. Despite her 5'2" stature, she has developed a striking prowess and fierce fighting style, allowing her to maintain an impressive 17-5 professional record.

Following her Road to UFC win, Shi shared that her parents remain unaware of her MMA career, believing she participates in traditional martial arts. "I don't think I'm going to mention it to them," Shi was quoted as saying. "For my parents, they are traditional Chinese parents, and they worry about me. Only a doctor or a lawyer; I don't have other choices," she added.

Shi emphasised that she would continue participating in the UFC and established that she would be a force to reckon with. "I think I'm going to be a dangerous opponent in the future. Good luck to my next opponent."

Pantoja vs Asakura
Alexandre Pantoja

Starting early: Hailing from Heilongjiang, China, Shi Ming (right) began training in taekwondo when she was 13 and transitioned to MMA in her 20s. PICS: GETTY IMAGES

